

Airport Hacks

Cheat Sheet — From Check-In to Gate in Record Time

THE PERFECT AIRPORT TIMELINE

- T-48h**Online check-in opens. Pick seats immediately.
- T-24h**Reconfirm flight. Download boarding pass offline.
- T-3h**International minimum. Clear security with time.
- T-2h**Security done. Gate first, then lounge or food.
- T-45m**Final boarding call. Be at the gate.
- T-20m**Gates close. No exceptions.

SECURITY SPEED HACKS

- ♦ Wear slip-on shoes — save 2 min every trip
- ♦ Belt, coins, jacket in bag BEFORE the queue
- ♦ Laptop in dedicated top-pocket — out in seconds
- ♦ Liquids bag visible at top of backpack
- ♦ TSA PreCheck / EU equivalent = separate fast lane

LOUNGE ACCESS WITHOUT BUSINESS CLASS

- Priority Pass**Amex Platinum, Curve Metal: free Priority Pass
- LoungeBuddy App**Day passes from €25–40. Book ahead.
- DragonPass**Standalone app — book individual visits worldwide
- Card Perks**Check your card: many include 2 free visits/year

Airport Hacks

Your Delay Rights

YOUR DELAY RIGHTS

1

EU261 Rule

EU flights delayed 3h+: €250–600 per person compensation.

2

AirHelp App

Auto-submit claims. Works worldwide.

3

Meal Vouchers

Ask at gate immediately after delay announced.

4

Hotel + Transfer

Airline must provide for overnight or 5h+ delays.

UPGRADE SECRETS

5

Dress Smart

Looking the part raises upgrade chances ×3.

6

Just Ask

"Any business availability today?" — costs nothing.

7

Check-In Last

Overbooked: last check-in is often bumped to business.

8

Bid Upgrade

Lufthansa, BA, KLM offer bid upgrades 48h before departure.

LAYOVER PLAYBOOK

2h

Stay airside. Gate first, then food.

4h

Lounge + power nap. Skip airport food prices.

6h+

Visa-free city visit — many airports allow it.